her mother did. I told Gertrude so, too.

5

On December 27, 1952, I took the train to New York. (It seemed sensible not to take the car when there might be snow.)

The next day was rather unusual. In the first place, after I had lunched at my parents', we all got into a car.

The first unusual point was that my parents were going somewhere together with both their sons. It was a new life for them now that the candy store was gone. They were going to the movies together, to the library, to museums. They ate dinner out with Stanley and me.

Second, it was Stanley's car we got into. He was twenty-three years old, could drive, and had a car of his own. I hadn't managed this until I had reached the age of thirty. But then, nine years made a difference. The society he lived in at twenty-three in the year 1952 was far different from the society I lived in at twenty-three in the year 1943.

The third and most unusual point, however, was that Stanley was driving us to Nyack so that we could visit Uncle Joe and Aunt Pauline. I had not seen them for over fourteen years. After some conversation, we drove them to some point in the Bronx where they could catch the train to Mount Vernon.

That is all I said in my diary and I remember hardly anything else on my own. Uncle Joe was very talkative, I remember, and rather quer-

ulous. He had been to Israel and he hadn't liked the treatment he got there. I don't recall his showing any interest in either myself or Stanley.

After Uncle Joe and Aunt Pauline got out of the car, I said, "Oh heck, I forgot to ask them about Cousin Martin."

"It's a good thing you didn't," said my mother, censoriously. "He's dead."

I was stunned into silence and my parents didn't say another word about it. Such was their marked reluctance to speak about it that I never got around to asking what happened, either then, or ever. When I thought of it, my parents weren't around to answer my questions; when they were around, I never thought of it.